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HIS GLOBAL CONCLAVE – EDITION 3.0

"Where Young Minds Meet to Debate, Deliberate and Lead."

UNITED NATIONS SECURITY COUNCIL

BACKGROUND GUIDE

Agenda: Current Conflict in the Middle East

Committee: United Nations Security Council (UNSC)
Committee Format: Crisis Simulation
Agenda: Current Conflict in the Middle East
Official Committee Language: English

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Letter from the Executive Board
2. Introduction to the Committee
3. Understanding the Agenda
4. Historical Background
5. The Current Situation in the Middle East
6. Major Areas of Conflict and Concern
7. The Humanitarian Situation

8. International Law and the United Nations Framework
9. The Role and Limitations of the Security Council
10. Country Profiles and National Interests
11. The Crisis Committee Framework
12. Directives: Format, Structure, and Submission
13. Debate Procedure and Committee Expectations
14. What the Executive Board Expects from Delegates
15. Questions Every Delegate Should Consider
16. Research Guidelines and Suggested Sources

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1. LETTER FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Honourable Delegates,

Welcome to the United Nations Security Council.

The Middle East remains one of the most politically complex and dangerous regions in the world. Its conflicts are rarely confined to a single border. A military operation in one territory can affect neighbouring states. An attack on commercial shipping can disrupt international trade. A failed diplomatic initiative can weaken a ceasefire, while a single decision by a national government may create consequences far beyond its immediate intentions.

This committee has been designed to reflect that reality.

You will not be participating in a conventional MUN committee where delegates spend most of their time delivering prepared speeches and negotiating a Draft Resolution. This is a crisis-style committee. Events may develop rapidly, positions may change, and the actions taken by one delegation may force every other delegation to reconsider its approach.

There will be no Draft Resolutions. Delegates will work through directives and direct debate. Every proposed action should have a purpose, a responsible actor, and a realistic path to implementation.

We expect delegates to understand the country they represent. Its alliances matter. Its limitations matter. Its past decisions matter. You should not represent your own personal political views; you should represent your country's interests as accurately as possible, while remaining prepared to negotiate when the situation demands it.

We also expect meaningful debate.

A series of uninterrupted speeches will not solve the crisis. Delegates must engage with one another, question claims, challenge weak proposals, defend their own decisions, and negotiate specific outcomes. If another delegate proposes a ceasefire mechanism, ask how it will be monitored. If a country offers humanitarian assistance, ask how it will reach civilians. If a delegation threatens sanctions, ask what result those sanctions are intended to achieve.

Do not speak merely to be noticed. Speak because you have something to contribute.

The Executive Board values preparation, political understanding, clear reasoning, practical decision-making, and respectful disagreement. Delegates are encouraged to be assertive, but aggression towards fellow delegates will not be mistaken for strong diplomacy.

The crisis will not necessarily offer easy answers. Your task is to make decisions despite that uncertainty.

We look forward to a committee marked by serious debate, thoughtful negotiation, and meaningful participation.

Regards,
The Executive Board
United Nations Security Council

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2. INTRODUCTION TO THE COMMITTEE

The United Nations Security Council is the principal UN organ responsible for maintaining international peace and security. Its work involves responding to threats to peace, considering measures to prevent conflict, and addressing situations that may endanger stability between states or within a region.

The Council operates in a difficult political environment. Its members may share an interest in preventing a wider war while disagreeing sharply over who is responsible for the conflict, which measures should be adopted, and what concessions should be required from the parties involved.

These disagreements are central to the committee.

The agenda, *Current Conflict in the Middle East*, covers a regional crisis involving interconnected political, military, humanitarian, economic, and diplomatic concerns. It cannot be approached as though every development is separate from the others.

A conflict affecting Gaza may influence relations between Israel and neighbouring states. Escalation involving Iran may affect Gulf security and international shipping. Instability in Yemen can affect the Red Sea and the Bab al-Mandab Strait. Developments in Syria may affect border security, displacement, and regional relationships.

Delegates must therefore examine both the immediate situation and its wider consequences.

2.1 The Committee's Objective

The purpose of this simulation is to develop and evaluate actions that could reduce immediate risks, address humanitarian needs, prevent further escalation, and create conditions for a more stable political situation.

Delegates will be expected to:

- Assess crisis developments and identify their consequences.
- Formulate country-specific responses consistent with their assigned roles.
- Negotiate with other delegations and challenge proposals that lack practical value.
- Coordinate national actions where cooperation is possible.
- Submit directives that establish clear and realistic measures.
- Reconsider earlier decisions when new information changes the situation.

The committee will not require every country to agree on every issue. In fact, disagreement is expected.

The objective is not to produce artificial consensus. It is to make the strongest possible decisions within the political and practical limits of the crisis.

2.2 A Crisis Committee, Not a Resolution Committee

The committee will use directives as its sole formal written instrument for proposing actions.

Delegates will not prepare or submit Draft Resolutions. Traditional resolution-writing procedures should not be treated as the centre of committee work.

Instead, delegates should focus on actions such as initiating diplomatic contact, proposing a humanitarian arrangement, reviewing national security measures, coordinating with willing partners, or responding to a newly announced development.

A directive must identify what a country intends to do. General declarations of concern are not enough.

A delegate representing Egypt, for example, might propose a specific diplomatic consultation concerning humanitarian access. A delegate representing India might propose a national contingency plan for affected citizens. A delegate representing China might offer to facilitate negotiations between willing parties.

These are different actions serving different national interests. They may complement one another, but they should not be treated as interchangeable.

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3. UNDERSTANDING THE AGENDA

3.1 What Does "Current Conflict in the Middle East" Mean?

The agenda is deliberately broad because the region's conflicts are interconnected.

It includes the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, the security situation surrounding Israel and Lebanon, tensions involving Iran and other regional powers, instability in Yemen, developments in Syria, threats to maritime trade, and the wider humanitarian consequences of armed violence.

The agenda does not imply that all these conflicts have the same cause or that every country in the region is a direct participant in every confrontation.

Some states are directly involved in hostilities. Others are mediators, aid providers, neighbouring states, security partners, or countries affected by economic disruption.

A delegation must determine where its country fits into the crisis and what influence it can realistically exercise.

3.2 Why the Conflicts Are Connected

Several factors connect the different theatres of the regional crisis.

Security relationships: Governments maintain alliances and security partnerships that influence their responses to attacks and military operations.

Armed groups: Some conflicts involve non-state armed groups whose activities affect state security, border arrangements, and regional diplomacy. Their relationship with governments varies and must be assessed individually.

Geography: The region contains important maritime routes, border crossings, energy infrastructure, and transport corridors. Instability in one area can affect access and security elsewhere.

Political legitimacy: Governments disagree over territorial claims, occupation, sovereignty, recognition, security guarantees, and the political future of disputed territories.

Humanitarian consequences: Civilian casualties, displacement, damaged infrastructure, and restrictions on essential supplies may affect several countries simultaneously.

International competition: Major powers may disagree over sanctions, military assistance, diplomatic pressure, and the role of the Security Council.

These connections make the crisis difficult to resolve through a single measure.

A ceasefire may reduce immediate violence without settling the political dispute. Humanitarian assistance may save lives without ending hostilities. Sanctions may impose costs but also create wider economic consequences. Military pressure may produce short-term gains while increasing the risk of retaliation.

Delegates should examine both the intended benefits and the foreseeable costs of their proposals.

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4. HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

The present crisis cannot be understood without considering the historical developments that shaped regional politics. This section provides a starting point, not a complete history of every conflict.

4.1 The Israeli-Palestinian Conflict

The Israeli-Palestinian conflict has roots in competing national movements, disputes over territory and political sovereignty, the end of British rule in Palestine, the establishment of Israel in 1948, and the displacement of large numbers of Palestinians.

The 1967 war resulted in Israel's occupation of the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, and the Gaza Strip, among other territories. Questions concerning occupation, settlements, borders, Jerusalem, Palestinian statehood, refugees, security, and recognition have remained central to the conflict.

The Oslo Accords of the 1990s established a framework for interim Palestinian self-government and negotiations. They did not resolve the core disputes.

Gaza has experienced repeated rounds of armed conflict, blockade-related restrictions, severe damage to infrastructure, and humanitarian emergencies. The political division between the Palestinian Authority, which exercises limited self-government in parts of the West Bank, and Hamas, which exercised de facto authority in Gaza before the later conflict and governance changes, has complicated Palestinian political representation and administration.

The attacks led by Hamas on 7 October 2023 killed civilians and members of the Israeli security forces and involved the taking of hostages. Israel subsequently launched a major military campaign in Gaza. The conflict caused extensive destruction, mass displacement, civilian deaths, and a profound humanitarian emergency.

The later ceasefire and political initiatives did not eliminate the underlying disputes. By October 2026, UN reporting continued to describe serious humanitarian needs and violence affecting Gaza and the West Bank. <Cite refs={["turn857019search4","turn857019search15"]}/>

For the committee, the central questions concern civilian protection, humanitarian access, the status of hostages and detainees, security guarantees, governance, Palestinian self-determination, and the possibility of a durable political settlement.

4.2 Iran and Regional Security

Iran has played a significant role in regional politics through its national security policy, relationships with governments and armed organizations, missile and drone capabilities, and disputes with Israel and the United States.

Iran's government presents its regional policies in terms of national security, deterrence, and resistance to foreign pressure. Its opponents argue that Iranian support for certain armed groups contributes to regional instability and threatens their security.

Disputes over Iran's nuclear programme have also shaped relations between Iran and several Western governments. International concern has focused on nuclear proliferation, verification, sanctions, and the risk of direct military confrontation.

In 2026, direct military escalation involving Iran, Israel, and the United States further widened the regional crisis. Subsequent diplomatic arrangements and ceasefire efforts faced serious difficulties. The consequences extended to maritime routes, energy markets, and regional security. <Cite refs={["turn857019search1","turn857019search2"]}/>

Delegates should consider how deterrence, negotiations, sanctions, military action, and regional security arrangements affect one another.

4.3 Lebanon and Israel

The border between Israel and Lebanon has experienced repeated periods of tension and armed confrontation, particularly involving Israel and Hezbollah.

Security Council Resolution 1701, adopted in 2006, called for a cessation of hostilities and established measures relating to the area between the Blue Line and the Litani River, including the role of the Lebanese Armed Forces and the UN Interim Force in Lebanon.

The situation deteriorated significantly during the regional escalation of 2024 and subsequent developments. By 2026, renewed fighting and fragile diplomatic arrangements continued to raise concerns over civilian casualties, displacement, territorial sovereignty, and the risk of a wider war.

UN reporting in June 2026 described extensive displacement in Lebanon and the killing of UN peacekeepers amid escalating hostilities. It called for a comprehensive ceasefire and a diplomatic settlement. <Cite refs={["turn857019search1","turn857019search11"]}/>

The committee must consider how a reduction in hostilities could be monitored, how civilians could return safely, and how Lebanon's sovereignty and Israel's security concerns might be addressed.

4.4 Yemen and Maritime Security

Yemen's prolonged conflict has involved competing political authorities, armed groups, foreign involvement, and a severe humanitarian emergency.

The country's position near the Bab al-Mandab Strait makes developments there important to international shipping. The Strait connects the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden and forms part of a major route between Europe and Asia.

Attacks on commercial vessels, military responses, and threats to maritime traffic have increased the risk that a local conflict could affect international trade.

UN reporting in October 2026 described a renewed deterioration in Yemen's security situation, with hostilities spreading across several frontlines. <Cite refs={["turn857019search14","turn857019search2"]}/>

Delegates should distinguish between the internal conflict in Yemen and the wider maritime security problem. They are connected, but they are not the same issue.

4.5 Syria and Regional Instability

Syria's conflict produced extensive destruction, displacement, foreign military involvement, and the fragmentation of authority across different areas.

Changes in political control have not automatically resolved security concerns or the humanitarian needs of the population. Border security, the status of armed groups, reconstruction, refugees, territorial sovereignty, and the presence of foreign forces remain relevant to regional stability.

For the committee, Syria raises questions about national sovereignty, the limits of foreign intervention, humanitarian assistance, and the risks of allowing a local security incident to become a regional confrontation.

Delegates should research the current political and institutional situation before proposing actions. They should not assume that a single government exercises effective control over every territory or armed actor.

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5. THE CURRENT SITUATION IN THE MIDDLE EAST

The situation should be treated as a developing crisis rather than a static conflict with one clearly defined front.

The following assessment reflects reporting available in October 2026. It establishes the background for debate; it does not predict which developments the Executive Board will introduce during committee.

5.1 Gaza and the West Bank

Gaza remains a central humanitarian and political concern. Continuing violence, damaged infrastructure, displacement, shortages of essential supplies, and restrictions affecting humanitarian operations create serious risks for civilians.

OCHA's October 2026 reporting described continued attacks and civilian casualties in Gaza, concerns about further displacement, and significant shortages affecting shelter, fuel, health care, and water services. It also reported continued violence and displacement in the West Bank. <Cite refs={["turn857019search4"]}/>

Delegates should consider the following questions:

- What specific measures could improve the delivery of humanitarian assistance?
- How could parties address alleged ceasefire violations?
- What arrangements could protect hospitals, shelters, and humanitarian personnel?
- How could the risk of forced displacement be addressed?
- What security and governance arrangements would be required for a more durable settlement?

The debate should not stop at identifying suffering. Delegates must examine which actors can take which steps, what obstacles stand in the way, and how progress could be assessed.

5.2 Iran and the Gulf

Direct confrontation involving Iran has increased the danger of attacks crossing national borders and has affected the security calculations of governments across the region.

The Gulf's importance to energy production and maritime trade gives escalation consequences well beyond the immediate combatants.

Possible responses include diplomatic communication, military deconfliction, negotiations over nuclear issues, maritime security arrangements, and measures to protect civilian infrastructure.

Each approach has limits. Military deployments may deter an attack but may also be interpreted as preparation for further hostilities. Economic pressure may influence government decisions while also affecting trade and essential supplies. Diplomatic talks may create opportunities for restraint but can fail if the parties disagree on basic security requirements.

Delegates must assess these trade-offs instead of assuming that one policy will solve every aspect of the crisis.

5.3 Lebanon and the Northern Border

Renewed fighting between Israel and Hezbollah has raised concerns about the possibility of a broader conflict and the displacement of civilians on both sides of the border.

The problem includes more than the immediate exchange of attacks. It also involves the authority of the Lebanese state, the role of armed groups, the implementation of existing Security Council decisions, and the ability of displaced civilians to return safely.

Potential actions include diplomatic engagement, mechanisms for reporting incidents, humanitarian assistance, and support for arrangements consistent with Lebanese sovereignty and applicable Security Council mandates.

Any proposed monitoring mechanism must specify who will operate it, how reports will be verified, and what happens when a violation is alleged.

5.4 Yemen and the Red Sea

Developments in Yemen may affect maritime security and the wider regional balance.

A response focused entirely on protecting shipping may fail to address the conflict inside Yemen. A response focused entirely on domestic political negotiations may overlook immediate risks to commercial vessels and seafarers.

Delegates should assess both concerns.

Possible actions include diplomatic engagement, cooperation on maritime incident reporting, humanitarian assistance, and measures intended to reduce the risk of attacks on civilian shipping.

Any maritime security proposal must explain its legal basis, geographical scope, participating states, and safeguards for civilian vessels.

5.5 Regional Diplomacy

Regional governments have different relationships with the principal parties. Some maintain diplomatic or security partnerships with Israel; others have strong political disagreements with Israel or the United States. Some have channels of communication with Iran. Others are concerned primarily with border stability, humanitarian pressures, or economic disruption.

These relationships can make a country useful as a mediator, but they can also limit the country's credibility with particular parties.

A delegation should ask whether its country can realistically influence the actor it intends to approach. It should also consider whether a proposed initiative would require a neutral intermediary, a joint diplomatic effort, or direct negotiations between the parties.

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6. MAJOR AREAS OF CONFLICT AND CONCERN

6.1 Protection of Civilians

Civilian protection is a central issue under international humanitarian law.

Parties to an armed conflict must distinguish between civilians and combatants and between civilian objects and military objectives. They must comply with the rules of proportionality and take feasible precautions in attack. The deliberate targeting of civilians is prohibited.

Delegates should consider how their proposed actions could reduce risks to civilians in practice.

Possible measures include improving humanitarian access, supporting medical services, establishing reliable communication channels, monitoring reported incidents, and pressing parties to comply with their legal obligations.

A directive should not use civilian protection as a vague justification for an action that has no clear protective purpose or ignores foreseeable harm.

6.2 Humanitarian Access

Humanitarian access may be affected by border closures, insecurity, damaged roads, restrictions on supplies, administrative barriers, fuel shortages, and disagreements over inspection procedures.

Delegates should consider the practical requirements of delivering assistance.

A credible proposal should identify the supplies needed, the intended recipients, the route or access mechanism, the relevant permissions, the organization responsible for delivery, and the method for confirming that assistance reaches civilians.

Humanitarian assistance should not be treated as a bargaining tool that permits the deliberate denial of essential relief to civilians.

6.3 Hostages, Detainees, and Missing Persons

Hostage-taking is prohibited under international humanitarian law. The treatment of detainees and persons deprived of liberty is governed by applicable legal protections.

The status of hostages, detainees, and missing persons can be a major obstacle in negotiations.

Delegates may consider diplomatic engagement, information-sharing arrangements, access for relevant humanitarian organizations, or proposals for exchanges negotiated by the parties concerned.

Any proposal should distinguish between hostages, prisoners of war where that status applies, and other detainees. These categories do not have identical legal rules.

6.4 Armed Groups and State Responsibility

The region includes armed organizations with varying degrees of political, military, and territorial control.

A state may support, oppose, negotiate with, or fight against an armed group. These relationships differ considerably between countries.

Delegates must not automatically treat every armed organization as an agent under the complete control of a particular government. Nor should they assume that a government can guarantee an armed group's compliance simply by making a diplomatic statement.

When proposing an action involving an armed group, delegates should identify the relevant channels of influence and explain what cooperation is actually possible.

6.5 Maritime Security

The Red Sea, Bab al-Mandab Strait, and Strait of Hormuz are important to international shipping and energy markets.

Threats to navigation can increase shipping costs, disrupt deliveries, and expose seafarers to danger.

Delegates should consider the distinction between protecting navigation, conducting military operations, and resolving the underlying political conflict.

A maritime directive should establish the proposed objective, participating states, legal authority, coordination arrangements, and safeguards for civilian shipping.

6.6 Economic Pressure and Sanctions

Sanctions, trade restrictions, financial measures, and diplomatic isolation may be used to influence a government's behaviour.

Their effectiveness depends on the target, the objectives, the level of international cooperation, and the availability of alternative economic relationships.

Delegates should ask what behaviour a proposed measure is intended to change, how compliance would be assessed, and what consequences the measure could have for civilians or regional trade.

A national government may propose measures within its own authority. A directive cannot independently impose binding Security Council sanctions unless the relevant Council procedure and authority have been satisfied.

6.7 Displacement and Refugees

Conflict-related displacement creates immediate humanitarian needs and longer-term challenges involving housing, education, employment, health care, and public services.

Neighbouring states may face pressure on infrastructure and public finances. Displaced people may also face risks of exploitation, discrimination, family separation, or unsafe return.

Delegates should consider assistance to host communities as well as displaced populations. They should also distinguish voluntary, safe, and dignified return from arrangements that expose people to further danger.

6.8 Accountability and Verification

Competing accounts of an incident are common during armed conflict. Governments and armed groups may present different versions of events, while information may be incomplete or deliberately misleading.

Delegates should not assume that the first report is necessarily accurate.

A monitoring or investigative proposal should identify how information would be collected, which sources could be consulted, how claims would be verified, and how uncertainty would be recorded.

The purpose of verification is not to protect a particular country's reputation. It is to establish a credible basis for decisions.

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7. THE HUMANITARIAN SITUATION

Humanitarian needs must remain central to committee deliberations.

The impact of conflict is not limited to the immediate casualties of an attack. Civilians may lose access to clean water, medical treatment, food, electricity, education, and shelter. Damaged infrastructure can create risks long after active hostilities decrease.

The World Health Organization's regional reporting on the 2026 escalation describes injuries, displacement, damage to health facilities, disrupted treatment, and obstacles to the movement of medical supplies. <Cite refs={["turn857019search0"]}/>

7.1 Key Humanitarian Priorities

Delegates should examine:

- Safe access to food, water, and essential medical supplies.
- Protection of hospitals, health workers, and humanitarian personnel.
- Emergency shelter and support for displaced families.
- Access to essential services, including electricity and sanitation.
- Assistance for children, older people, persons with disabilities, and other vulnerable civilians.
- The restoration of basic infrastructure.
- Adequate funding for humanitarian operations.

These priorities require different resources and different forms of cooperation.

A government with substantial financial resources may be able to fund relief operations. A neighbouring country may be able to facilitate access. Another state may offer transport or medical supplies. An international organization may have the operational experience required to distribute assistance.

A useful directive identifies the specific contribution each participant is prepared to make.

7.2 Humanitarian Aid Must Be Practical

Delegates should avoid submitting directives that simply call for increased humanitarian assistance without explaining how the assistance would be delivered.

Consider a proposal to provide emergency medical supplies to Gaza. A practical directive would need to address procurement, transport, access permissions, security, distribution, and monitoring.

The same principle applies to assistance for displaced civilians in Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, or elsewhere in the region.

Delegates should also distinguish between a promise of funding and a confirmed financial commitment. An announced contribution is not the same as a delivered shipment, and a planned operation is not the same as a completed one.

7.3 Humanitarian Action and Political Negotiations

Humanitarian assistance and political negotiations may occur at the same time, but they should not be confused with one another.

Emergency relief addresses immediate needs. Negotiations address political or security disagreements. One may support the other, but progress in one area does not guarantee progress in the other.

Delegates should be prepared to support practical humanitarian measures even when they strongly disagree with another country's wider political position.

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8. INTERNATIONAL LAW AND THE UNITED NATIONS FRAMEWORK

This section introduces the legal principles most relevant to the committee. It is not a substitute for detailed legal research.

8.1 The UN Charter

The Charter of the United Nations establishes the organization's purposes, principles, and institutional framework.

Article 2(4) prohibits the threat or use of force against the territorial integrity or political independence of a state, or in another manner inconsistent with the purposes of the United Nations.

Article 33 identifies peaceful means through which parties to disputes that may endanger international peace and security should seek solutions. These include negotiation, enquiry, mediation, conciliation, arbitration, judicial settlement, and other peaceful means of their choice.

Articles 39–42 establish the Security Council's framework for determining threats to peace and considering measures in response.

Article 51 recognizes the inherent right of individual or collective self-defence if an armed attack occurs, subject to the Charter's conditions.

Delegates should understand that invoking a legal principle does not automatically establish that every action taken in its name is lawful. The circumstances, applicable rules, and factual basis matter.

8.2 International Humanitarian Law

International humanitarian law regulates conduct during armed conflict.

Its protections include rules governing distinction, proportionality, precautions in attack, humane treatment, and the protection of medical and humanitarian personnel.

The application of particular treaty provisions depends on the circumstances and legal classification of the conflict. Delegates should avoid assuming that every rule applies in precisely the same way to every situation.

8.3 Occupation and Self-Determination

Questions of occupation, territorial control, and Palestinian self-determination are central to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict.

Delegates should consult relevant Security Council resolutions, international court materials, and authoritative UN documentation when assessing these issues.

They should distinguish between a country's political position and the legal findings or obligations established by relevant international instruments.

8.4 Security Council Resolutions

Several Security Council resolutions are especially relevant to regional discussions.

- **Resolution 242 (1967):** Addresses principles concerning a peaceful settlement following the 1967 war.
- **Resolution 338 (1973):** Calls for a ceasefire and the implementation of Resolution 242, alongside negotiations.
- **Resolution 1701 (2006):** Addresses the cessation of hostilities and security arrangements relating to Lebanon and Israel.
- **Resolution 2334 (2016):** Addresses Israeli settlements in the occupied Palestinian territory.
- **Resolution 2728 (2024):** Called for an immediate ceasefire during Ramadan 2024 and the immediate and unconditional release of all hostages, alongside other demands.
- **Resolution 2803 (2025):** Endorsed a framework concerning the Gaza conflict and associated transitional arrangements.

Delegates should read the actual texts of relevant resolutions rather than relying exclusively on summaries. They should also check subsequent decisions and developments to understand which provisions remain relevant.

8.5 Sovereignty and Consent

The fact that the Security Council has responsibility for international peace and security does not mean that every national government is subordinate to every individual delegate's proposal.

The Council acts through its established procedures and powers. A national directive may establish a country's own proposed actions, but it does not automatically authorize operations in another state's territory.

Where a proposal involves foreign military deployment, access to territory, the use of national facilities, or cooperation by an independent institution, the necessary authority and consent must be considered.

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9. THE ROLE AND LIMITATIONS OF THE SECURITY COUNCIL

The Security Council consists of fifteen members in the real United Nations: five permanent members and ten elected members.

The permanent members are China, France, the Russian Federation, the United Kingdom, and the United States of America. They possess veto power over substantive decisions of the Council.

The other ten seats are filled through elections for two-year terms.

The conference's country list contains twenty delegations. It therefore represents an expanded simulation format rather than the actual composition of the Security Council.

Delegates should follow the conference's specific rules for membership, voting, directive approval, and the powers of the Chair. The real-world Council's procedures should not automatically be assumed to govern every aspect of the simulation.

9.1 What the Council Can Do

Subject to the Charter and applicable procedures, the Security Council can:

- Call upon parties to pursue peaceful settlement.
- Adopt decisions addressing threats to international peace and security.
- Establish sanctions regimes.
- Authorize certain enforcement measures.
- Establish or mandate peace operations within the relevant legal framework.
- Request reports and support monitoring arrangements.
- Encourage diplomatic initiatives and humanitarian coordination.

9.2 What the Council Cannot Do Through a Delegate's Directive Alone

A directive submitted by one delegation cannot independently:

- Make another sovereign state accept a demand.
- Establish a binding international sanctions regime without the required Council action.
- Deploy foreign armed forces into another state's territory without the necessary authority.
- Command an independent armed group to follow its instructions.
- Guarantee that a ceasefire will be observed by every party.
- Declare unverified allegations to be proven facts.

Delegates should distinguish between proposing an action, authorizing an action within their authority, and successfully implementing an action.

This distinction is particularly important in a crisis committee, where the pressure to respond quickly can lead to unrealistic proposals.

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11. THE CRISIS COMMITTEE FRAMEWORK

11.1 The Purpose of Crisis Procedure

Crisis procedure is intended to allow the committee to respond to developing situations through debate, negotiation, and directives.

The Executive Board may introduce new information, announce changes in the situation, or present consequences arising from earlier decisions. Delegates must assess the credibility and significance of that information and decide whether their existing approach remains appropriate.

The committee should not treat each update as an unrelated event. Actions taken earlier may affect the options available later.

For example, a government that has offered to facilitate negotiations may need to respond if one party refuses to attend. A country that has promised humanitarian funding may need to address delays in delivery. A proposal concerning maritime security may need revision if the threat expands to another route.

The quality of a delegation's response depends on its ability to connect new information with its previous decisions.

11.2 Crisis Updates

A crisis update may contain information about military developments, diplomatic initiatives, humanitarian conditions, economic disruptions, or changes in national policy.

Delegates should ask:

- What does the update establish?
- Which information remains uncertain?
- Which countries are directly affected?
- What immediate decisions are required?

- Does the update change the feasibility of an existing directive?
- Which delegations should be consulted before action is taken?

A delegate should not automatically assume that every reported allegation has been independently verified.

Where the information is incomplete, the directive may propose further assessment, diplomatic clarification, or other steps that do not depend on treating uncertain claims as established facts.

11.3 National Decision-Making

Delegates should act within the authority of the country they represent.

A country may propose a diplomatic initiative, offer humanitarian assistance, review national policy, or request cooperation from another government. A delegate should not automatically assume that their country can command a foreign military, control an independent armed group, or guarantee a decision by another government.

When a proposal depends on another actor's cooperation, the directive should state the dependency.

11.4 Consequences and Accountability

The Executive Board may assess the likely consequences of proposed actions and introduce developments that reflect the outcome of the crisis.

A directive should therefore be treated as a serious decision, not merely a document intended to demonstrate activity.

Delegates should consider whether an action is likely to achieve its stated objective, what might go wrong, and how the country would respond if the outcome differs from expectations.

An unsuccessful proposal is not automatically evidence of poor delegation. An unrealistic proposal that ignores obvious constraints is a different matter.

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12. DIRECTIVES: FORMAT, STRUCTURE, AND SUBMISSION

Directives are the sole formal written instrument of this committee. Draft Resolutions will not be used.

Directives should translate debate into specific actions. They may be unilateral, joint, or intended to coordinate several related national measures.

There is no fixed page limit for directives. However, their length should reflect the complexity of the action being proposed.

12.1 Types of Directives

National action directives: Propose measures to be undertaken by the submitting country within its authority.

Joint directives: Set out agreed actions by two or more participating countries.

Diplomatic directives: Propose meetings, negotiations, communication channels, or mediation efforts.

Humanitarian directives: Address the delivery of assistance, medical support, shelter, food, water, and other essential services.

Security directives: Address national security measures, incident reporting, or other measures within the relevant legal and institutional authority.

Economic directives: Address national economic measures, proposed funding, or coordination relating to trade and essential supplies.

Monitoring directives: Propose methods for collecting, assessing, and reporting information about developments relevant to the crisis.

Emergency directives: Address urgent developments requiring immediate consideration.

These categories are descriptive. The Executive Board will determine admissibility and procedural treatment under the committee's rules.

12.2 Required Format

Every directive should include the following information.

A. Administrative Details

- Directive title.

- Submitting country or countries.
- Date and time of submission.
- Directive category.
- Relevant crisis update, if applicable.
- Participating countries.
- Intended recipient or implementing institution.

B. Situation Assessment

Explain the event or problem requiring action. Distinguish confirmed information from allegations, assessments, and assumptions.

C. National Objective

State the result the submitting country intends to achieve. The objective should be specific and relevant to the current situation.

D. Operative Provisions

Identify the proposed actions. Each provision should name the responsible actor, the action, the relevant scope, and the expected result.

E. Authority and Consent

Explain the legal or institutional basis for the action. Identify any additional approvals or cooperation required.

F. Resources and Implementation

Identify the relevant personnel, funding, equipment, institutions, and logistical arrangements. Estimates should be labelled as estimates.

G. Timeline

State when the action is expected to begin and when it should be reviewed or completed, where appropriate.

H. Risks and Safeguards

Identify foreseeable risks and explain how they may be reduced.

I. Reporting and Review

Explain how implementation will be assessed and what information will be used to determine whether the objective has been achieved.

12.3 Example of a Country-Specific Directive

Title: Emergency Diplomatic Consultation on Humanitarian Access

Submitting Country: Arab Republic of Egypt

Category: Diplomatic and Humanitarian

Situation: Continued restrictions and insecurity affecting humanitarian delivery create a need for urgent coordination.

National Objective: To facilitate discussions on practical arrangements for the delivery of humanitarian assistance.

Operative provisions:

1. The Egyptian delegation proposes convening an emergency diplomatic consultation with willing representatives of relevant parties and humanitarian institutions.
2. The consultation shall identify the immediate logistical and administrative obstacles affecting the delivery of essential supplies.
3. Egypt shall request information on the assistance available, the access arrangements required, and the relevant security concerns.
4. Participating parties shall be invited to identify specific actions they are prepared to undertake within their respective authority.
5. The submitting delegation shall provide the committee with an update on the proposed consultation and any commitments confirmed by participating parties.

Implementation: The proposed meeting would proceed subject to the availability and agreement of the intended participants.

Expected outcome: Identification of practical steps that could improve humanitarian coordination.

This example demonstrates the difference between proposing a diplomatic action and claiming that the action has already succeeded.

12.4 Joint Directives

A joint directive must identify the commitments of each participating country separately.

A country may offer funding while another provides transport or diplomatic access. Each contribution should be stated clearly.

Delegates should not include another country's name as a participant without that delegation's agreement.

The directive should identify the shared objective, individual responsibilities, resource commitments, coordination arrangements, and reporting procedure.

12.5 Revising an Existing Directive

If a crisis update changes the situation, a delegation may propose revising an earlier directive.

The revised document should identify the original directive, explain why a change is required, and specify which provisions should be replaced, expanded, or withdrawn.

Delegates should not assume that a directive has been implemented simply because it has been submitted. Its status will depend on the committee's procedure and any subsequent crisis information.

12.6 What Makes a Directive Effective?

A strong directive answers five questions:

1. What problem is being addressed?
2. What action is being proposed?
3. Who is responsible for carrying it out?
4. What authority, resources, and cooperation are required?
5. How will the committee determine whether the action has worked?

A lengthy directive that fails to answer these questions is weaker than a concise document that answers them clearly.

Annexes, tables, timelines, and detailed assessments may be included whenever they serve a practical purpose. There is no page limit, but every section should contribute to the action being proposed.

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13. DEBATE PROCEDURE AND COMMITTEE EXPECTATIONS

Debate is the central activity of this committee.

Delegates are expected to speak, but speaking alone is not the measure of participation. A delegate who repeatedly delivers long statements without engaging with other countries may contribute less to the committee than a delegate who asks a precise question, exposes a serious weakness in a proposal, and negotiates a workable alternative.

The Executive Board expects delegates to debate with one another rather than deliver disconnected speeches.

13.1 Substantive Debate

A substantive contribution should do at least one useful thing.

It may challenge an argument, clarify a country's position, identify a practical obstacle, suggest a specific action, respond to a crisis update, or help establish common ground between delegations.

Delegates should listen to the debate and respond to what has actually been said.

Repeating a country's general position without addressing the issue under discussion will not advance the committee.

For example, if a delegate argues that an immediate ceasefire is necessary, another delegate may ask how alleged violations would be monitored, what guarantees are required, or how the arrangement would address the security concerns of the parties involved.

That is debate.

Simply delivering another speech in favour of peace without addressing the questions raised is not.

13.2 Challenge Proposals Directly

Delegates are encouraged to question the feasibility of proposals.

Questions may concern:

- Whether the submitting country possesses the necessary authority.

- Whether the required resources are available.
- Whether the proposal depends on cooperation that has not been secured.
- Whether the proposed timeline is realistic.
- Whether the action could worsen the situation.
- Whether the same objective could be achieved through a less risky measure.
- How success would be measured.

Such questions should be specific and relevant. The aim is to test the proposal, not to embarrass the delegate who submitted it.

13.3 Negotiation Is Part of Debate

Negotiation should not be postponed until delegates begin drafting directives.

Delegates should discuss their objectives, identify areas of agreement, and establish what each country is prepared to contribute.

A country may agree with the objective of another delegation while rejecting its proposed method. That distinction creates room for negotiation.

For example, two countries may agree that maritime security needs improvement but disagree over the scope of a proposed operation. They could negotiate a narrower arrangement focused on information-sharing, incident reporting, or protection of civilian shipping.

The committee should encourage such practical compromises without requiring delegates to abandon their national positions.

13.4 Short, Relevant Speeches

Delegates should make their point and leave room for others to respond.

Long speeches are not automatically bad. A complex legal argument or a detailed explanation of national policy may require time. But repetition, irrelevant background information, and extended statements that do not engage with the current discussion should be avoided.

Delegates should ask themselves whether their next paragraph adds anything new.

If it does not, it probably does not need to be delivered.

13.5 Questions and Responses

Delegates should use questions to obtain information, test proposals, and clarify disagreements.

Questions should not become disguised speeches. A delegate asking a question should ask a question rather than deliver a lengthy argument and attach a question at the end.

Responses should address the point raised. Delegates may challenge the assumptions behind a question, but they should not evade every difficult issue by repeating prepared statements.

The Chair may intervene where questions and answers become repetitive or unnecessarily confrontational.

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14. WHAT THE EXECUTIVE BOARD EXPECTS FROM DELEGATES

The following standards apply throughout the committee.

14.1 No Parallel Debate

There shall be **no parallel debate**.

Only one recognized speaker may address the committee at a time, subject to the procedure established by the Chair. Delegates must not conduct competing debates across the room, shout over the recognized speaker, or attempt to run separate discussions while formal debate is taking place.

Informal negotiations may be permitted when the Chair allows them. They must take place within the time and manner prescribed by the committee.

A delegate who disagrees with another country's argument should wait for the appropriate opportunity to respond. Interrupting, shouting, or speaking over another delegate does not strengthen an argument.

The Chair may call delegates to order when parallel debate disrupts committee proceedings.

14.2 Maintain Decorum

Delegates must maintain professional conduct throughout the simulation.

This includes respecting the Chair's rulings, following speaking procedures, avoiding unnecessary interruptions, and refraining from personal attacks.

Disagreement is expected. Disrespect is not.

Delegates may strongly criticize another country's policy, challenge the logic of a proposal, or question the credibility of an argument. They must not turn these disagreements into insults directed at the person representing that country.

14.3 Be Civil, Even During Heated Debate

The subject matter is serious. The committee may discuss attacks, civilian deaths, displacement, hostages, military operations, and allegations of violations of international law.

Delegates should approach these issues with appropriate seriousness.

Mocking civilian suffering, celebrating harm to civilians, using slurs, or making personal remarks about another delegate will not be accepted as effective diplomacy.

Civil conduct does not require political agreement. Delegates may be forceful and uncompromising in defending their country's position while remaining respectful towards fellow participants.

14.4 Debate Rather Than Deliver Needless Speeches

The Executive Board places significant emphasis on direct engagement.

Delegates should avoid treating every speaking opportunity as a chance to repeat their opening statement. A useful intervention responds to the discussion, adds information, or advances a decision.

The following habits should be avoided:

- Repeating the same national position without adding new reasoning.
- Delivering speeches that are unrelated to the immediate crisis.
- Listing broad principles without explaining how they apply.
- Making claims about other countries without supporting them.
- Speaking at length merely to appear active.
- Ignoring questions raised by other delegations.
- Repeating points already made by several speakers without adding a new argument.

A concise, well-reasoned challenge is often more valuable than a lengthy speech.

Delegates will be expected to show that they are listening to the room.

14.5 Challenge Ideas, Not People

Delegates may question another country's motives, but such questions should remain relevant to policy and evidence.

A delegate may ask why a country is proposing a particular measure, what national interest it serves, or whether the proposed action is consistent with its earlier position.

They should not use personal insults or assume that a fellow delegate's real-world identity reflects the policy being represented.

Criticism should focus on the position, the evidence, and the proposed action.

14.6 No Unnecessary Grandstanding

Grandstanding occurs when a delegate prioritizes appearing forceful or important over contributing to the committee's work.

It may take the form of dramatic threats without a credible plan, repeated denunciations that do not lead to action, or speeches intended mainly to attract attention.

Strong diplomacy is not the same as loud diplomacy.

A delegate may adopt a firm position, reject a proposal, or threaten lawful national measures where appropriate. The delegate should be prepared to explain the objective, feasibility, and consequences of that position.

14.7 Be Prepared to Defend Every Proposal

A directive is not a substitute for debate.

The submitting delegation should be able to explain why the proposed action is necessary, what authority supports it, what resources it requires, and what could go wrong.

Other delegates may question these points. The submitting delegation should respond with reasoning rather than treating every challenge as a personal attack.

If a proposal is flawed, delegates should be willing to revise it.

Changing a position after receiving new information is not necessarily a weakness. Refusing to reconsider an obviously unworkable proposal may be.

14.8 Follow the Rules of Procedure

Delegates must follow the Chair's instructions concerning speaking time, motions, questions, informal negotiation, directive submission, and voting where applicable.

The committee is crisis-oriented, but that does not mean procedure is optional.

Where the rules do not explicitly address a situation, delegates should seek clarification from the Chair rather than assume that their preferred interpretation automatically applies.

14.9 Avoid Misrepresentation

Delegates should not knowingly present invented information as verified fact.

They may propose hypothetical actions, make political arguments, and discuss intelligence assessments within the simulation. However, they should distinguish between established information, official claims, estimates, and assumptions.

A country may dispute another country's account of an event. It should explain the basis of its disagreement rather than simply declaring the opposing account false.

14.10 Be Active Between Speeches

Committee participation does not begin and end at the speaker's podium.

Delegates should listen, take notes, consult relevant countries, prepare questions, negotiate possible joint actions, and assess the implications of new information.

A delegate who remains silent during debate and then submits an unrelated directive has missed an important part of the committee's purpose.

The Executive Board expects delegates to connect their written actions to the arguments and negotiations taking place in the room.

14.11 Work Towards Practical Outcomes

Delegates are not required to agree on everything. They are expected to make serious attempts to address the crisis.

Where consensus is impossible, delegates should identify which measures remain feasible.

A group of countries may disagree over the long-term political future of a territory but still be able to coordinate humanitarian assistance. Governments may disagree over the cause of an escalation but share an interest in preventing attacks on commercial shipping.

Practical cooperation should not be abandoned simply because broader political disagreements remain unresolved.

14.12 The Chair's Authority

The Chair is responsible for maintaining orderly proceedings and applying the committee's rules.

The Executive Board may intervene to address interruptions, parallel debate, personal attacks, repeated irrelevance, or procedural confusion.

Delegates should raise procedural concerns through the appropriate channels. Disagreeing with a ruling does not permit a delegate to disregard it or disrupt the committee.

The Board may also clarify directive requirements, establish deadlines, and determine the procedural status of submissions in accordance with the conference's rules.

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15. QUESTIONS EVERY DELEGATE SHOULD CONSIDER

Delegates should use the following questions to guide their research and preparation.

15.1 National Position

- What are my country's principal interests in the Middle East?
- Which governments are its partners, and where do important disagreements exist?
- What actions has my country taken recently?
- What legal or political constraints affect its options?
- What resources can it realistically commit?

15.2 The Crisis

- Which developments pose the most immediate threat to regional stability?
- Which civilians or communities face the greatest immediate risks?
- What is known, and what remains uncertain?
- Which countries can influence the actors involved?
- What could cause the situation to deteriorate further?

15.3 Possible Actions

- What can my country do independently?
- Which actions require cooperation from another state?
- What would my country need to obtain approval for?
- How much time would implementation require?
- What risks could the action create?
- What evidence would demonstrate that the action has worked?

15.4 Debate Preparation

- Which countries are likely to support my proposal?
- Which countries are likely to oppose it, and why?
- What is the strongest objection another delegate could raise?
- What evidence or reasoning supports my position?
- What compromise could preserve my country's central objective?
- Which proposals from other countries deserve support, modification, or rejection?

15.5 Crisis Adaptation

- What would cause my country to change its position?
- What happens if a diplomatic initiative fails?
- How would my country respond if a partner withdraws support?
- What contingency measures would be required?
- Which previous directives might need to be revised?

Delegates should not prepare answers only to defend their own positions. They should also prepare to question the proposals of other countries.

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16. RESEARCH GUIDELINES AND SUGGESTED SOURCES

The background guide provides a starting point. Delegates are expected to conduct additional research before committee.

Research should cover the current situation, the country's official position, its capabilities, relevant international law, and recent developments that may affect the crisis.

16.1 Recommended Sources

United Nations Security Council

Official resolutions, meeting records, presidential statements, and reports.

https://www.un.org/securitycouncil/

United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Humanitarian situation reports, access updates, displacement figures, and information on emergency needs.

https://www.unocha.org/

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs — Occupied Palestinian Territory

Reporting on Gaza and the West Bank.

https://www.ochaopt.org/

World Health Organization

Health emergencies, damage to health facilities, medical supply requirements, and regional health assessments.

https://www.who.int/

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees

Information on displacement, refugee protection, and humanitarian needs.

https://www.unhcr.org/

United Nations Secretary-General

Official statements and briefings on regional developments.

https://www.un.org/sg/

International Committee of the Red Cross

Information on international humanitarian law, civilian protection, detainees, and humanitarian access.

https://www.icrc.org/

Official government websites

Delegates should consult the foreign ministry or relevant government department of their assigned country to establish its official position.

16.2 How to Evaluate Information

Delegates should compare reports from different sources, especially when an incident is disputed.

They should distinguish between:

- Official government statements.
- Reports from international organizations.
- Independent journalism.
- Expert analysis.
- Allegations made by parties to a conflict.
- Information that has not been independently verified.

A government statement is useful for understanding that government's position. It does not automatically establish that every factual claim in the statement is correct.

Similarly, an early media report may be incomplete and may later be corrected.

Delegates should avoid relying entirely on social media posts, anonymous claims, or outdated statistics.

16.3 Research Your Country's Capabilities

A strong crisis delegate understands more than their country's official position.

Research should include the institutions responsible for foreign policy, the country's diplomatic relationships, its economic interests, relevant military or humanitarian capabilities, and any constraints that may affect implementation.

A proposal should be ambitious enough to matter but realistic enough to defend.

Delegates should also be aware that public information may not establish every operational detail. Where exact figures are unavailable, proposals should acknowledge uncertainty instead of inventing precise commitments.

FINAL NOTE FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

This committee is intended to reward preparation, serious debate, and sound decision-making.

Delegates should not measure their performance by the number of speeches delivered or the number of directives submitted. Neither quantity guarantees quality.

A delegation that submits several unrealistic directives may achieve less than one that develops a single practical proposal, negotiates the necessary support, and responds effectively when circumstances change.

The Executive Board expects delegates to engage directly with the arguments of others, defend their national positions with evidence, remain civil during disagreement, and take responsibility for the consequences of the actions they propose.

Debate first. Negotiate seriously. Submit directives that can be defended and implemented.

The purpose of the committee is not to produce the most words. It is to make better decisions under pressure.